



Delaware County Council Meeting February 28th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n_k-5Tv2oXc
Publication Date	2023-02-28T17:27:06Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: February 28, 2023

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order at [00:00:07](#) by presiding officer President Jessica Piper. The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Councilmember Dan [00:00:12](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Council members explicitly identified or responding to roll call include Mr. Flanagan, Mr. Hughes, Ms. Katz, Mr. Slasseter, Mr. Webb, Ms. Whitehead, and President Jessica Piper. (Note: Names and spelling reflect transcript roll calls).
 - **Absent:** None noted in the roll call.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jessica Piper, President.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:12](#).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved by roll call vote (Disposition: Passed Unanimously) following a motion by Dan and a second by Eugene [00:01:23](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the January 24, 2023, Council meeting were approved by roll call vote (Disposition: Passed Unanimously) following a motion by Dan and a second by Bill [00:01:46](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:13](#) **Guest Presentation: Prosecutor's Office Financial and Staffing Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Hoffman, Delaware County Prosecuting Attorney, joined by Chief Deputy Zach Craig.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Prosecutor Hoffman presented an overview of an impending financial and operational emergency within the prosecutor's office, driven by a surge in violent crime and homicides (rising from 3 murders in 2018 to 11 in 2022) and severe understaffing. According to an IPAC commission study, Delaware County is the 16th most populated Indiana county but the 9th most understaffed prosecutor's office (operating at 49% of needed attorney staffing based on weighted caseload caps). Hoffman detailed three primary funding pressure points to be formally requested next month: litigation expenses (autopsy consultation fees, expert toxicologists, psychiatric defenses, and trial transcripts), computer replacement costs, and deputy prosecutor salary increases. Currently, deputy prosecutors start at non-competitive wages compared to the public defender's office or state agencies like the Department of Children's Services (DCS), leading to unfilled positions (such as Judge Fike's court in Circuit Court 4) and severe burnout. Hoffman proposes raising base salaries for deputy prosecutors to \$85,000 with a performance/experience-based stipend tier up to \$10,000. Council members discussed the timing outside regular budget season, the distinction between general fund and public safety LIT funds, and the challenges of department-specific salary adjustments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; formal proposals scheduled for the March meeting.
- [00:34:07](#) **Budget Transfers (County General Fund)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads / Council President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and approved routine fund transfers primarily representing backfilling positions for employees who left. All transfers carried a net-zero impact on budgets and received favorable recommendations from the finance committee.
 - **Items Included:**
 - Clerk's Office [00:34:07](#): Deputy Clerk internal reallocations (\$\$27,807.40\$).

- Communications [00:35:39](#): Communication Tech reallocations across lines B101, E132, and H109 (\$\$34,019.35\$; \$\$33,846.16\$; \$\$34,615.39\$).
 - Jail [00:36:49](#): Correctional Officer reallocations (\$\$30,152.00\$).
 - Treasurer [00:37:28](#): Assistant Cashier reallocations (\$\$27,509.40\$).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously across respective roll call votes.
- **[00:38:10](#) Budget Transfers (Other Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - DOC Grant [00:38:10](#): Line reallocations (\$\$28,067.34\$ and \$\$1,800.00\$).
 - Supreme Court Grant [00:38:58](#): Travel/training reallocated to drug screens and client incentives (\$+\$4,683.95\$ and \$+\$1,000.00\$). Elizabeth from Community Corrections clarified client incentives cover treatment funding, gift cards, and hygiene needs for program participants.
 - Health Department [00:40:22](#): Environmental Health Specialist reallocations (\$\$41,016.14\$).
 - JLOIT [00:41:29](#): Correctional Officer reallocations (\$\$34,115.44\$).
 - JLOIT Department 137 [00:43:05](#): Investigator and Grant Administrator reallocations separating grant stipends from base salaries (\$\$3,846.14\$; \$\$26,926.03\$).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously by roll call vote.
- **[00:44:51](#) New Additional Appropriations (Individual Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council considered and approved standard appropriations out of specific non-general funds, accompanied by auditor balance reports:
 - Assessor Assessment Fund (1224) [00:45:01](#): Longevity, insurance, and mileage shortfall adjustments (\$+\$245.00\$).
 - Plan Commission Fund (1180) [00:46:00](#): Professional services (comp plans, etc.), travel, printing, dues, schooling, public meetings, and computer equipment (\$+\$172,500.00\$).
 - EMS Capital Improvements (4910) [00:47:55](#): Motorola repeater transmitter (\$+\$16,473.00\$).
 - GIS Map Fund (1150) [00:48:31](#): Computer support, professional services (aerial photography), travel, printing, schooling, dues, and GIS equipment (\$+\$120,380.00\$).
 - Local Health Maintenance (1168) [00:50:36](#): Permit assistant and environmental director salary adjustments (\$+\$1,520.00\$). Jamie Bain noted this accounts for grant cycles due in October and correcting division lead pay disparities.

- High-Tech Crimes Unit Ball Brothers (92-14) [00:52:46](#): Training and forensic software reallocation (\$\$17,462.24\$ total). Chuck Zimmer confirmed grant expiration/reapplication.
 - Project Income (2501) [00:54:05](#): Director of Education and peer recovery coach positions (\$+\$37,577.00\$).
 - Sales Disclosure Fund (1131) [00:54:46](#): BPP postcard printing, form printing, schooling, and dues (\$+\$20,150.00\$). James Carmichael noted this covers business personal property notices and form 11 assessments.
 - Surveyor Cornerstone Perpetuation (1202) [00:56:45](#): Professional services for cornerstone location and maintenance (\$+\$30,000.00\$). Tom Borchers explained funds pay local surveyors as needed based on workload.
 - Unsafe Building Fund (1207) [00:57:55](#): Recording fees and unsafe building demolition bids (\$+\$43,271.67\$).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** All appropriations approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- [00:59:51](#) **"Magic Motion" Salary Ordinance Integration**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President Jessica Piper / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard procedural motion to incorporate all approved financial transfers into the county salary ordinance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) following a motion by Eugene and a second by Dan [00:01:23 format style].
- [01:00:49](#) **Board Appointment: Yorktown Public Library Board of Trustees**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President Jessica Piper.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of a letter from library director Liz Rozelle recommending the reappointment of Samantha Taylor to a four-year term ending March 31, 2027. Taylor has served as board president for seven years and led facility improvements.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) to reappoint Samantha Taylor, following a motion by Dan and a second by Eugene [01:02:11](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public signed up for public comment, and no comments were received via Facebook or the county email portal [01:37:16](#).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- **Bill Hughes (Tax Abatement & Rules Committee Report) 01:03:01:** Reported on a tax abatement committee orientation emphasizing revenue-positive projects. Additionally, introduced a draft questionnaire sent to council members and officeholders to establish formal, written rules of procedure and bylaws for transparent council operations.
- **Sheriff Tony Skinner 01:07:53:** Presented annual reports detailing jail meal costs (\$1.60 average per meal), the law enforcement pension plan portfolio status, out-of-county inmate housing revenues (\$848,090 collected in 2022), inmate population tracking, and departmental training hours. Provided an update on ongoing negotiations with the U.S. Marshal Service regarding per diem rates for housing federal inmates.
- **Alan Wisely & Shannon Henry (Plan Commission) [01:13:01 / 01:21:01]:** Discussed recruiting challenges and the under-market salary for the Executive Director position following Marta's passing. Proposing an increase to \$68,000-\$70,000+\$ to stay competitive with similar jurisdictions. Noted a commitment of \$20,000\$ in edit funds from the Mayor of Muncie and ongoing work toward an interlocal agreement for shared city funding.
- **Councilmember Discussion 01:32:49:** Discussed securing funding for live-streaming budget meetings in September using upgraded AV equipment, and noted that ARP fund restrictions remain under broad review by commissioners. Sarah Hodges was introduced as the new Administrative Assistant 01:24:21.
- **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for Tuesday, March 28, 2023, at 9:00 AM 01:37:25.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Dan and a second by Eugene, approved by roll call vote 01:37:29.